
Vida: Balance

Official Game Guide

Master the Art of Living

A Strategic Board Game of Life Balance

Manage Health, Happiness, Money, and Knowledge

Every decision shapes your future.

EST. 2026

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1 Introduction

Welcome to Vida: Balance!

Life is a beautiful journey of balancing multiple priorities. **Vida: Balance** is a strategic board game where players manage four essential life pillars: Health, Happiness, Money, and Knowledge.

The game challenges you to make thoughtful decisions, adapt to unexpected life events, and maintain harmony across all areas of your life. True success comes not from excelling in one area, but from achieving balance in all.

Core Philosophy

"Life is about balance. If any pillar falls to zero, you face a LIFE CRISIS. Master the art of living by keeping all four pillars strong."

2 Game Overview

2.1 What's in the Box?

Game Board (64 spaces)

1 Six-sided Die

2-4 Player Tokens

16+ Life Event Cards

Score Tracker Sheets

This Game Guide

2.2 The Four Life Pillars

Pillar	Icon	Description
Health		Physical wellbeing, fitness, self-care, and mental health
Happiness		Joy, relationships, life satisfaction, and positive experiences
Money		Financial stability, career success, and material resources
Knowledge		Education, skills, wisdom, and personal growth

Your Life Score

Your total life score is the **sum** of all four pillars:

$$\text{Life Score} = + + +$$

The player with the highest Life Score at the end wins!

3 Setup Instructions

Step 1: Unfold the Game Board – Place it on a flat surface where all players can reach.

Step 2: Choose Your Token – Each player selects a colored token and places it on the **START** space.

Step 3: Set Starting Stats – All players begin with **5 points** in each pillar:

$$= 5, \quad = 5, \quad = 5, \quad = 5$$

Step 4: Shuffle Life Event Cards – Place the deck face down in the designated area.

Step 5: Prepare Score Sheets – Each player tracks their stats throughout the game.

Step 6: Determine First Player – The youngest player goes first. Play proceeds clockwise.

Important!

Always keep your score sheet updated. If any pillar reaches **0**, you immediately face a **Life Crisis** and are eliminated from the game!

4 Gameplay Mechanics

4.1 Turn Structure

On Your Turn:

1. **Roll the Dice** – Roll the six-sided die to determine movement.
2. **Move Your Token** – Advance the number of spaces shown.
3. **Land on a Space** – Apply the space's effect (gain/lose points).
4. **Draw Card (if applicable)** – If you land on **LIFE EVENT**, draw a card.
5. **Update Stats** – Record all changes on your score sheet.
6. **End Turn** – Pass the dice to the next player.

4.2 Space Types

Space Type	Icon	Effect
Health Spaces		+1 to +3 Health
Happiness Spaces		+1 to +3 Happiness
Money Spaces		+1 to +3 Money
Knowledge Spaces		+1 to +3 Knowledge
Life Event		Draw a random Life Event Card
START		Starting point / Lap completion
FINISH		End of game

4.3 Movement Rules

- Movement is always **forward** along the board path.
- If you pass or land on **START**, you complete a lap (no bonus points).
- The first player to reach or pass **FINISH** triggers the end of the game.
- All players get one final turn after **FINISH** is reached.

5 Life Event Cards

5.1 What Are Life Event Cards?

Unexpected Moments

Life is unpredictable! Life Event Cards represent the surprises, opportunities, and challenges that come your way. Drawing a card can boost your stats, create new opportunities, or present difficult choices.

5.2 Sample Cards

READ 5 BOOKS

+2 Knowledge

You completed a reading challenge and expanded your mind.

PROMOTION

+2 Money

You got promoted at work with a significant raise.

MARATHON

+3 Health

You trained hard and completed a marathon.

BIRTHDAY PARTY

+2 Happiness

Friends threw you a surprise celebration.

GRADUATED

+3 Knowledge

You finished your degree with honors.

VACATION

+3 Happiness

You took time off to travel and relax.

VOLUNTEER

+2 Happiness

You helped at a local shelter and felt fulfilled.

GYM STREAK

+2 Health

30 days straight at the gym. You feel strong!

6 Life Crisis Rule

6.1 What is a Life Crisis?

CRISIS!

If at **any point** during the game one of your pillars reaches **0** or below, you immediately face a **Life Crisis**.

Consequences:

- Your journey ends immediately
- You are eliminated from the game
- Your token is removed from the board
- Remaining players continue without you

How to Avoid Crisis

- Monitor your lowest pillar constantly
- Prioritize spaces that boost your weakest stat
- Use Life Event cards strategically
- Don't take unnecessary risks
- Remember: balance is better than extremes!

6.2 Crisis Examples

- **Health Crisis:** Burnout, injury, or illness from neglecting self-care
- **Happiness Crisis:** Depression, loneliness, or loss of purpose
- **Money Crisis:** Bankruptcy, debt, or financial ruin
- **Knowledge Crisis:** Skill obsolescence, missed opportunities

7 Winning the Game

7.1 End Game Conditions

The game ends when:

1. A player reaches or passes the **FINISH** space, OR
2. Only one player remains (others eliminated by Life Crisis)

7.2 Calculating the Winner

Final Scoring

Once the game ends, all remaining players calculate their **Final Life Score**:

$$\text{Final Score} = + + +$$

The player with the **highest Final Score** is declared the winner and crowned *Master of Life Balance*!

7.3 Tie-Breakers

In case of a tie:

1. Player with higher **Health** wins
2. If still tied, higher **Happiness** wins
3. If still tied, higher **Money** wins
4. If still tied, higher **Knowledge** wins
5. If still tied, **shared victory!** Both players win.

8 Strategy Guide

8.1 Pro Tips for Beginners

Tip 1: Monitor Your Lowest Stat

Your weakest pillar is your biggest risk. Always know which stat is lowest and prioritize boosting it.

Tip 2: Don't Ignore Any Pillar

Specializing too much in one area leaves you vulnerable. A balanced approach is safer and often leads to higher total scores.

Tip 3: Life Events Are Your Friend

Don't fear Life Event spaces! Cards often provide significant bonuses that can save you from crisis.

Tip 4: Plan Your Route

Look ahead at the board. If your Health is low, aim for Health spaces. Strategic movement is key!

8.2 Advanced Strategies

- **Pillar Synergy** – Some combinations work well together (e.g., Knowledge + Money)
- **Risk Management** – Calculate the probability of landing on beneficial spaces
- **Card Counting** – Track which Life Events have been drawn
- **Positioning** – Block opponents by landing on key spaces
- **Crisis Prevention** – Keep all pillars above 3 points minimum

9 Frequently Asked Questions

Q1: What happens if I land exactly on a Life Event space?

You draw one card from the top of the Life Event deck and apply its effects immediately.

Q2: Can stats go above a maximum limit?

No maximum limit! The higher your stats, the better your Life Score. Keep growing!

Q3: What if multiple players land on the same space?

All players share the space. Tokens can stack on the same square.

Q4: How do I track my stats?

Use the provided score sheets or a pen and paper. Digital version tracks automatically.

Q5: Can I play alone?

Yes! The digital version supports single-player mode. Try to beat your high score!

Q6: How long does a game take?

Average game time is 30-60 minutes, depending on number of players.

10 Quick Reference

10.1 Space Effects Summary

Icon	Space	Effect
	GYM	+2
	HEALTHY FOOD	+2
	RELAX	+1
	HEALTH	+3
	HAPPY TIME	+1 or +2
	TRAVEL	+2
	VOLUNTEER	+1 or +2
	WORK	+1
	INVESTMENT	+2
	BUSINESS	+2 or +3
	STUDY	+2
	COURSE	+2
	UNIVERSITY	+3
	LIFE EVENT	Draw a card
	START	Starting point
	FINISH	Game end

10.2 Card Effects Summary

Effect	Common Cards
+2 to +3 Knowledge	Read Books, Graduated, New Skill, Workshop
+1 to +3 Happiness	Vacation, Birthday, Volunteer, Good News
+1 to +3 Money	Promotion, Bonus, Side Hustle, Investment
+1 to +3 Health	Marathon, Gym Streak, Healthy Meal Plan

Find Your Balance. Master Your Life.

Vida: Balance — EST. 2026

11 Score Tracker

Turn	Health	Happiness	Money	Knowledge	Total
Start	5	5	5	5	20
Turn 1	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Turn 2	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Turn 3	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Turn 4	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Turn 5	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Turn 6	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Turn 7	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Turn 8	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Turn 9	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Turn 10	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
FINAL SCORE: _____					

Player Name: _____

Date: _____

Thank you for playing Vida: Balance!

May you always find balance in life.
